

Ram Padmanabhan

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
Ph.D. Electrical and Computer Engineering

Advisor: Melkior Ornik

Thesis: *Resource-Aware System Design and Resilience Quantification*

Urbana, IL, USA
August 2023 — Present

University of Michigan
M.S. Electrical and Computer Engineering

Advisor: Peter Seiler

Ann Arbor, MI, USA
August 2021 — April 2023

PES University
B. Tech Electronics and Communication Engineering

Advisors: Rajini Makam and Koshy George

Capstone Project: *Adaptive Iterative Learning Control*

Bengaluru, India
August 2017 — June 2021

PUBLICATIONS

Preprints and Submitted Material:

- [1] **R. Padmanabhan**, M. Fowler, K. Huff, M. Neubauer, and M. Ornik, “A Vision for STEM Higher Education in the Face of AI,” *EdArXiv: Nzdz3_v1*, May 2026.
- [2] **R. Padmanabhan** and M. Ornik, “Finite-time Reachability for Constrained, Partially Uncontrolled Nonlinear Systems,” *arXiv:2604.08327 [math.OC]*, Apr. 2026.
- [3] **R. Padmanabhan** and N. Mehr, “Robust Decentralized Multi-Agent Reinforcement Learning through Risk Sensitivity,” Apr. 2026.
- [4] R. Das*, **R. Padmanabhan***, M. Ornik, and P. Jagtap, “Energetic Resilience under Temporal Logic Specifications,” *arXiv:2604.14203 [eess.SY]*, Apr. 2026.
- [5] G. Puthumanai, **R. Padmanabhan**, J. Fuentes, N. Cruz, P. Padrao, R. Hernandez, H. Jiang, W. Schafer, L. Bobadilla, and M. Ornik, “Online Learning of Deceptive Policies under Intermittent Observation,” *arXiv:2509.14453 [cs.RO]*, Sep. 2025.
- [6] **R. Padmanabhan** and M. Ornik, “Ignore Drift, Embrace Simplicity: Constrained Nonlinear Control through Driftless Approximation,” *arXiv:2509.06188 [math.OC]*, Sep. 2025.

Journal Articles:

- [7] **R. Padmanabhan** and M. Ornik, “Approximate Energetic Resilience of Nonlinear Systems under Partial Loss of Control Authority,” *Automatica*, 187, May 2026.
- [8] **R. Padmanabhan**, A. Aspel, N. Ozay, and M. Ornik, “Mode-Prefix-Based Control of Switched Linear Systems with Applications to Fault Tolerance,” *IEEE Control Systems Letters*, 9, pp. 1784–1789, Jul. 2025 (presented at *64th IEEE Conference on Decision and Control (CDC)*, Dec. 2025).
- [9] **R. Padmanabhan** and P. Seiler, “Analysis of Gradient Descent with Varying Step Sizes using Integral Quadratic Constraints,” *IEEE Transactions on Automatic Control*, 70(1), pp. 587–594, Jan. 2025.
- [10] **R. Padmanabhan**, R. Makam, and K. George, “Multiple Estimation Models for Discrete-time Adaptive Iterative Learning Control,” *International Journal of Systems Science*, 55(10), pp. 2154–2171, Apr. 2024.
- [11] **R. Padmanabhan**, M. Shetty, and T. S. Chandar, “Discrete Robust Control of Robot Manipulators using an Uncertainty and Disturbance Estimator,” *Journal of Dynamic Systems, Measurement and Control*, 145(5): 051022, May 2023.

- [12] **R. Padmanabhan**, M. Shetty, and T. S. Chandar, “Discrete-Time Design and Applications of Uncertainty and Disturbance Estimator,” *International Journal of Robust and Nonlinear Control*, 31(10), pp. 4994–5015, Jul. 2021.

Conference Papers:

- [13] S. A. Dinkar, **R. Padmanabhan**, A. Clarke, P.-O. Gutman, and M. Ornik, “Analysis of the Unscented Transform Controller for Systems with Bounded Nonlinearities,” in *5th Modeling, Estimation and Control Conference (MECC)*, Pittsburgh, PA, USA, Oct. 2025.
- [14] **R. Padmanabhan** and M. Ornik, “Energetic Resilience of Linear Driftless Systems,” in *11th IFAC Symposium on Robust Control Design (ROCOND)*, Porto, Portugal, Jul. 2025. (Selected as Finalist, IFAC Young Author Award.)
- [15] **R. Padmanabhan**, C. Bakker, S. A. Dinkar, and M. Ornik, “How Much Reserve Fuel: Quantifying the Maximal Energy Cost of System Disturbances,” in *63rd IEEE Conference on Decision and Control (CDC)*, Milan, Italy, Dec. 2024.
- [16] **R. Padmanabhan**, M. Bhushan, K. K. Hebbar, R. Makam, and K. George, “Second-Level Adaptation and Optimization for Multiple Model Adaptive Iterative Learning Control,” in *Seventh Indian Control Conference (ICC)*, Mumbai, India, Dec. 2021, pp. 289–294.
- [17] S. Damodaran, **R. Padmanabhan**, R. Maahin, and S. Gurugopinath, “A Copula-Driven Unsupervised Learning Framework for Anomaly Detection with Multivariate Heterogeneous Data,” in *IEEE 31st International Workshop on Machine Learning for Signal Processing (MLSP)*, Gold Coast, Queensland, Australia, Oct. 2021.
- [18] **R. Padmanabhan**, M. Bhushan, K. K. Hebbar, R. Makam, and K. George, “A Novel Strategy with Multiple Models to Improve Performance of Adaptive Iterative Learning Control,” in *IEEE International Conference on Electronics, Computing and Communication Technologies (CONECCT)*, Bengaluru, India, Jul. 2021.
- [19] **R. Padmanabhan**, S. Damodaran, V. N. Batra, and S. Gurugopinath, “A Convolutional Neural Network Architecture for Camera Model Identification with Small Datasets,” in *IEEE International Conference on Electronics, Computing and Communication Technologies (CONECCT)*, Bengaluru, India, Jul. 2020.

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Joan and Lalit Bahl Fellowship	August 2025 — May 2026
Finalist, IFAC Young Author Award	July 2025
Graduate College Mentoring Certificate	May 2025
Joan and Lalit Bahl Fellowship	August 2024 — May 2025
Prof. CNR Rao Merit Scholarship	August 2017 — May 2020
Prof. MRD Merit Scholarship	August 2017 — May 2020

MENTORING

Undergraduate Research Apprenticeship Program (URAP)	August 2024 — May 2025
Mentored an undergraduate student at UIUC on the use of the particle filter for three-dimensional robot localization, and received the Graduate College Mentoring Certificate.	
Promoting Undergraduate Research in Engineering (PURE)	August — December 2023
Mentored a group of three undergraduates at UIUC in investigating the performance of different nonlinear Kalman filters on the problem of battery state-of-charge estimation. (One student subsequently joined our primary research group.)	

TEACHING

Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign	Urbana, IL, USA
<i>AE 498 ARO — Advanced Review of Basic Mathematics (Special “Online-only” Section)</i>	January — May 2026
Held office hours and constructed problems for homeworks and exams.	

Graduate Student Instructor, University of Michigan
EECS 460 — Control System Analysis and Design
Held two discussion sessions each week, with teaching evaluations among the University's highest.

Ann Arbor, MI, USA
January — April 2023

Graduate Student Instructor, University of Michigan
EECS 301 — Probabilistic Methods in Engineering
Held two discussion sessions each week, with teaching evaluations among the University's highest.

Ann Arbor, MI, USA
August — December 2022

SERVICE

Session Chair

Robotics and Control Session, [2026 Coordinated Science Laboratory Student Conference](#)

Peer Reviewer

Journals: Automatica; IEEE Control Systems Letters; IEEE Transactions on Automatic Control; IEEE Transactions on Control Systems Technology; IEEE Transactions on Industrial Electronics; IEEE Transactions on Systems, Man and Cybernetics; Journal of the Franklin Institute; Nonlinear Analysis: Hybrid Systems.

Conferences: American Control Conference (2025), IEEE Conference on Decision and Control (2024, 2025, 2026), IFAC Symposium on Robust Control Design (2025), Learning for Dynamics & Control Conference (2026), Modeling, Estimation and Control Conference (2025).

Member

IEEE Control Systems Society Technical Committee on Robust and Complex Systems

EXPERIENCE

Research Intern, Indian Institute of Technology, Bombay

Systems and Control Engineering

Used feedback linearization to achieve an upwind climb in gliding unmanned aerial vehicles with various wind gradient models, avoiding heavy computations from optimal control formulations.

Mumbai, India

December 2020 — May 2021

Research Intern, Indian Space Research Organization

Control and Digital Electronics Group

Studied the properties of the Linear and Ensemble Kalman Filter, applied to a one- and three-dimensional motion estimation problem.

Bengaluru, India

June — July 2019

OTHER TALKS & POSTERS

Posters:

12th Midwest Workshop on Control and Game Theory

Purdue University

Energetic Resilience under Temporal Logic Specifications

West Lafayette, IN, USA

April 2026

11th Midwest Workshop on Control and Game Theory

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Mode-Prefix-Based Control of Switched Linear Systems with Applications to Fault Tolerance

Urbana, IL, USA

April 2025

10th Midwest Workshop on Control and Game Theory

Northwestern University

How Much Reserve Fuel: Quantifying the Maximal Energy Cost of System Disturbances

Evanston, IL, USA

April 2024

Talks:

Prof. Murat Arcak Research Group

University of California, Berkeley

Analysis of Gradient Descent with Varying Step Sizes using IQCs [Online]

Berkeley, CA, USA

February 2023

Research at ECE (R@ECE) Colloquium

PES University

Discrete-Time Design and Applications of Uncertainty and Disturbance Estimator

Bengaluru, India

April 2021

MEMBERSHIPS

Graduate Student Member: IEEE; IEEE Control Systems Society; IEEE Signal Processing Society